WATCHMEN ON THE WALL — TODAY'S WATCH

Wednesday, October 14, 2026

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1. UPDATE — Houthis strike Aramco headquarters as Saudi Arabia attacks Houthi energy terminals — WELL-CORROBORATED An Aramco office tower was damaged and the Houthis declared Saudi airports and oil sites military targets while the Saudi coalition widened retaliation to fuel infrastructure in Yemen.

2. UPDATE — Russian strikes leave 600,000 without power, ending the one-night energy pause — WELL-CORROBORATED Russia acknowledged hitting six power plants in a 39-missile and 120-drone assault, collapsing the brief restraint that followed President Trump's claimed energy ceasefire.

3. UPDATE — Five shipping incidents in 48 hours as Iran expands pressure beyond Hormuz — WELL-CORROBORATED Independent maritime reporting shows the war's highest recent attack tempo against merchant vessels, with incidents now extending into the Gulf of Oman and waters near Qatar and the UAE.

1. UPDATE — Houthis strike Aramco headquarters as Saudi Arabia attacks Houthi energy terminals

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Saudi Arabia's Energy Ministry said an October 13 attack caused a limited fire at an administrative building in Saudi Aramco's Dhahran headquarters complex, without casualties. A company source told Reuters that a ballistic missile damaged the top three floors of an office tower. Saudi forces also reported intercepting missiles and drones aimed at Riyadh, Dhahran and Al-Kharj; falling debris injured four people, including a child, and damaged 15 homes.

The Houthis said they also targeted Riyadh's airport and an Aramco refinery, and warned international companies, workers and civilians to leave Saudi airports and oil facilities, which they declared military targets. The Saudi-led coalition struck Houthi-controlled energy terminals and fuel reserves in Yemen. The Houthi-run Health Ministry reported two deaths from Tuesday's strikes. Reuters and Associated Press.

What changed: Tuesday's report concerned Saudi defense-system failures and repeated airport attacks. The confrontation has now crossed into a verified hit on Aramco's operational headquarters, an explicit Houthi threat against the kingdom's oil network and Saudi attacks on the Houthis' fuel infrastructure.

Prophetic relevance: The widening exchange links an Iran-aligned force, Saudi Arabia, global energy infrastructure and Red Sea trade. It is a consequential regional-war development, but it remains directed at Saudi Arabia and Yemen rather than the Israel-centered invasion described in Ezekiel 38.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–13; Daniel 11; Matthew 24:6–8.

2. UPDATE — Russian strikes leave 600,000 without power, ending the one-night energy pause

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Russia's Defense Ministry said its forces struck four power plants in and around Kyiv and two in Kharkiv overnight. Ukrainian officials reported 39 ballistic missiles and more than 120 drones, damage to 30 energy facilities and at least 600,000 people without electricity. Three people were killed in Kyiv.

Russia still has not publicly accepted the "energy ceasefire" announced by President Trump. Ukraine says it has continued withholding attacks on Russian refineries. Reuters and Associated Press.

What changed: Tuesday brought one night without a confirmed Russian strike on Ukrainian energy targets. The latest assault directly targeted six power plants on a far larger scale, ending that observable pause and further undermining the claimed truce.

Prophetic relevance: A high-profile peace claim followed by expanding attacks illustrates the fragility of great-power diplomacy and the persistence of war. It is not Daniel 9:27's covenant involving Israel and does not establish Russia as Gog.

Scripture watch: Daniel 9:27; Matthew 24:6–7; Ezekiel 38:1–9.

3. UPDATE — Five shipping incidents in 48 hours as Iran expands pressure beyond Hormuz

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Maritime-security data and reports to the British navy-linked UKMTO recorded at least five incidents involving tankers and other commercial ships around Hormuz in 48 hours, matching the highest attack tempo of the war. The reported incidents included drone strikes and extended beyond the strait into the Gulf of Oman and waters near Qatar and the United Arab Emirates.

Two senior Iranian officials told Reuters that Tehran had changed the type, tempo and geographic scope of its attacks. A U.S. military official separately said Iran was using unarmed small-boat spotters after losing much of its radar capability. The U.S. Navy-led Joint Maritime Information Center continues to rate the threat to merchant shipping as "severe." Reuters and Associated Press.

What changed: Monday's report documented two attacked tankers near Hormuz. The attack rate has now increased to five incidents in two days, and the operational area appears to be spreading beyond the strait.

Prophetic relevance: Hormuz is not named in biblical prophecy, but Iran/Persia's growing ability to pressure international shipping, energy and prices warrants attention. This does not establish Ezekiel 38 or Revelation 6.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–9; Matthew 24:6–7; Revelation 6:5–6.

JEWISH CALENDAR — NEXT 7 DAYS

Friday evening–Saturday, October 16–17 — Shabbat Noach: Jerusalem candle lighting is 5:26 PM Friday, following the local custom of lighting 40 minutes before sunset. Standard Havdalah is 6:41 PM Saturday; communities using later conventions conclude afterward. The reading is Genesis 6:9–11:32, covering the Flood, God’s covenant with Noah and the dispersion at Babel.

No major Jewish festival or fast falls during October 14–20. Jewish days begin at sunset; candle lighting precedes sunset, while Havdalah follows halachic nightfall and varies by convention. Hebcal Jerusalem calendar.

SIGNS & ANNIVERSARY WATCH

October 16 at 22:56 UTC — 6:56 PM Eastern: The Moon reaches apogee, the farthest point of its monthly orbit from Earth.

October 18 at approximately 16:12 UTC — 12:12 PM Eastern: The Moon reaches first quarter. Orionid meteor activity is increasing, but the shower’s expected peak occurs just after this seven-day window, on October 21–22, under a bright waxing Moon.

No solar or lunar eclipse occurs during October 14–20. Assessment: astronomically routine; no demonstrated prophetic significance. NASA GSFC Sky Events Calendar and NASA October skywatching.

Modern State of Israel: Established May 14, 1948 — 78 years ago.

Jerusalem: Israel captured East Jerusalem and the Old City during the June 1967 Six-Day War — 59 years ago.

Neither reaches a new yearly anniversary this week. The establishment of the State of Israel and Israel’s later capture of East Jerusalem are distinct historical events; Jerusalem is a city, not a nation.

ANTICHRIST WATCH — BIBLICAL TRAITS, NOT ACCUSATIONS

No new candidate-relevant development.

This is a watchlist of documented traits and developments, not identification of any living person as the Antichrist. Relevant markers include extraordinary ascent and authority, a pivotal covenant involving Israel, exceptional political-military power, self-exaltation, blasphemy and persecution.

Key passages: Daniel 7; Daniel 9:27; Daniel 11; 2 Thessalonians 2; Revelation 13; 1 John 2.

What to Watch Next

1. Whether the Houthis strike additional Saudi airports or oil installations and whether Aramco reports operational disruption.
2. Whether Saudi attacks on Houthi fuel infrastructure expand into a sustained air campaign or produce direct outside military involvement.
3. Whether Russia continues mass attacks on Ukraine’s grid and whether Ukraine ends its unilateral refinery-strike pause.
4. Whether the five recent shipping incidents are formally attributed and whether attacks spread farther into the Gulf of Oman.
5. Any material Temple Mount prayer, access, enforcement, Third Temple or red-heifer development.